

The Premier's Own Words, and the Record

From "Your Province. Your Premier." on 880 CHED and QR Calgary, June 27, 2026. What was said about the AISH transition, next to the documented facts.

On June 27, 2026, Premier Danielle Smith answered questions about the move from AISH to ADAP on air. Below are her own words from that broadcast, placed beside what the documented record shows. We do not guess at anyone's intent. We compare what was said to what can be verified, and we let you decide.

For fairness: the Premier also said that people with severe disabilities who cannot work would be supported at the highest level. The statements below are the ones that sit in tension with the record.

ON AIR, JUNE 27:

"who on paper might look disabled, but they're actually able to support themselves and they just need pharmacare."

What the record shows:

Every person receiving AISH was assessed against a medical standard and found to have a severe disability that prevents earning a living. Eligibility requires a completed medical report and an adjudicated decision. By the program's own rules, the people on it met that test. Describing recipients as disabled only "on paper" casts doubt on assessments the government itself required and approved.

ON AIR, JUNE 27:

"The transition is going out to December of 2027 ... we want to preserve what people are making now."

What the record shows:

The transition benefit holds a person's amount at the current level only until the end of 2027. On January 1, 2028, that hold ends and the amount drops. On ADAP, the base is \$1,740, below the \$1,940 being held. So the amount is preserved until the end of 2027, then reduced. It is a hold with an end date, not a lasting preservation.

ON AIR, JUNE 27:

"this is the very unfortunate thing with the way the NDP is politicizing this ... They're terrifying the people ... we have a vulnerable population that is getting very anxious about it."

What the record shows:

The anxiety is a response to changes already in effect. As of July 1, 2026, the AISH single earnings exemption dropped from \$1,072 to \$350 per month, with every dollar above \$350 now deducted in full. The federal Canada Disability Benefit is clawed back. The couples reduction to 88 percent begins with the August benefit period. These are documented, current changes to people's incomes. Concern about them follows the facts.

ON AIR, JUNE 27:

“a lot of people who have the ability to do more stuck in a position where they reduce the amount that they work because they don’t want to lose their benefits.”

What the record shows:

As of July 1, 2026, the AISH earnings exemption was cut from \$1,072 to \$350 per month, and earnings above \$350 are now deducted dollar for dollar. Whatever discouraged working before, this change makes working less rewarding, not more. A person on AISH now keeps less of what they earn than they did the month before.

ON AIR, JUNE 27:

“I suppose we could take half the calls for the next 18 months on this issue, but we are not doing the full transition until December of 2027 ... There’s lots of time.”

What the record shows:

The volume of calls and messages reflects concern across the province. And while the full base change lands at the end of 2027, several changes are already in force. The earnings exemption cut and the benefit clawbacks took effect July 1, and the couples reduction begins in August. For many people, the impact is not years away. It is now.

This is how we do this. We do not tell you what to think about why. We place the words next to the record, and the gap speaks for itself. If you want to raise it, send this to your MLA and ask one question: which of these facts is wrong?

Quotations are from the broadcast of “Your Province. Your Premier.” on 880 CHED and QR Calgary, June 27, 2026. The record is verified against the AISH General Regulation (AR 96/2026) and the Government of Alberta ADAP fact sheet (May 12, 2026). We document effects, not intent.

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